

TRUTH CHANGES YOU

It's always easier to live in a lie if no one has ever told you the truth. When I was a kid, my dreams weren't much bigger than the house I grew up in. As I said earlier, I came from an amazing family, and we always had *enough*. Early on, that's all I thought was possible for me, so I didn't really think about building wealth and moving on from that small town. Then, one afternoon after baseball practice, I experienced an unexpected paradigm shift. My coach took me and some other players home, and he dropped off one of the kids from the nicer part of town first. I remember looking out the car window at the house my teammate was walking into. It was big and beautiful. It had a perfectly manicured lawn. It had nice cars in the driveway. It looked a lot different than my house, and I remember thinking something like, *It must be nice to have all that*.

Then, probably sensing what I and another teammate in the car were thinking, my coach turned around and looked at us in the back seat. He said, "Boys, this life is possible for you." I couldn't escape what he said. No one had ever told me that before. No one had ever even mentioned the possibility of me living in a house like that or having the things my wealthy friends had. It was hard to believe, because I didn't have the advantages they had. But I went home that night and realized I had two options: I could pout and be upset about what I didn't have, or I could start getting a clear picture in my head of what I wanted to chase. Seeing how someone else lived could have been either my fuel or my finality. It could drive me where I wanted to go, or it could leave me sitting where I had always been. I chose to drive forward, and I haven't stopped since.

If you're where I was back then, allow me to do for you what my coach did for me that day. It's my job—and my joy—to tell you that building wealth is possible for you. Will it be easy? Heck no! Nothing worth doing ever is. I never said becoming a millionaire was *easy*; I just said it was